

A field guide to Claude on autopilot

Claude Routines.

The version of Claude that keeps working after your laptop is closed. What routines are, how they work, and how to set up your first one in about ten minutes.

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READ TIME

4 minutes

The Problem With "Scheduled" Tasks

If you've set up a scheduled task in Claude Cowork, you've probably hit this: you set it to run every morning at 7am, close your laptop, and nothing happens. 7am comes and goes.

That's because Cowork's scheduled tasks run **on your computer**. If the machine is asleep, so is the task. The whole point of "set it and forget it" quietly falls apart.

Routines fix that. A routine is a Claude task that runs in the cloud, on Anthropic's own servers, on a schedule you pick. Your laptop can be in a bag. You can be on a flight. The task still fires.

THE CORE IDEA

A routine bundles a prompt, a connector or two, and a trigger, then runs it automatically on Anthropic's infrastructure. Cowork's scheduled tasks need your computer on. Routines don't.

What a Routine Actually Is

Strip away the terminology and a routine is three things stacked together:

1 A prompt

The instruction you'd normally type into Claude — "scan my inbox and flag anything urgent," or "check for new pull requests and summarize them."

2 A trigger

What kicks it off: a clock (every morning at 7am), a webhook (another app pings a URL), or a GitHub event (a new PR opens).

3 Connectors

The apps Claude reads from and writes to while it works — Gmail, Slack, Drive, your codebase, whatever you've hooked up.

Save those three things together and you have a routine. From there it runs whenever the trigger fires — no laptop required.

Where Routines Live Right Now

As of today, routines are a feature inside **Claude Code** (the web version, at claude.ai/code), not yet inside Cowork directly. Anthropic has a consistent pattern of shipping features to Code first and bringing them to Cowork once they're proven — so this is worth learning now, before it lands everywhere.

Set Up Your First Routine

1 Check your plan

Routines need Pro, Max, Team, or Enterprise. Pro gets 5 runs a day, Max gets 15, Team/Enterprise get 25.

2 Open claude.ai/code/routines

Or, inside any Claude Code session, type **/schedule** and describe what you want — Claude walks you through the same setup.

3 Describe the task in plain English

Be specific about what and when. The clearer the prompt, the better the result.

PROMPT · DAILY INBOX SWEEP

Every weekday at 7am, go through my Gmail inbox from the last 24 hours. Pull out the 5 most important emails I should reply to today. Write them as a short briefing in a Google Doc called "Inbox Brief" so I can read it with coffee.

4 Pick "Scheduled" as the trigger

Set the cadence and time, then save.

5 Connect what the prompt needs

If it mentions Gmail, Drive, or Slack, make sure those connectors are already live on your account.

6 Close your laptop

That's the whole point. The routine runs in the cloud next time the schedule fires — you'll find the result waiting in whatever connector you pointed it at.

Three Routines Worth Trying First

Morning Briefing

calendar + inbox summary · runs 6:30am

Friday Wrap

recap the week, post to Slack · runs Fri 4pm

Content Watch

scan competitors, drop ideas in Drive · runs Mon 8am

Plan Limits to Know

P

Pro — 5 runs/day

Plenty for a daily briefing plus a weekly recap.

M

Max — 15 runs/day

Room for hourly checks and multiple daily routines.

T

Team / Enterprise — 25 runs/day

Built for teams automating across shared tools.

Do This Today

01 Open claude.ai/code/routines and look around for two minutes.

02 Write down one task you wish just happened automatically every morning.

03 Turn it into a Scheduled routine using the prompt template above.

— NeuraFlow Academy